

Jacob Vespa

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EDUCATION

B.Sc. Game Programming / Diploma in Game Design | *Brock University & Niagara College* Sep 2022 – Jun 2026

Joint 4-year program | Graduating April/June 2026

- Studied game programming with coursework spanning systems design, AI, graphics, and software engineering
- Completed multiple full-cycle game projects in teams of 5 to 11 members using Unity, C#, and industry-standard tools
- Applied Agile-style workflows including task tracking, code reviews, weekly check-ins, and GDD documentation

PROJECTS

Tech Lead, Programmer and Systems Designer | *Cave Crashers* Sep 2024 – Apr 2025

2D co-op arcade wave shooter | Unity, C# | Team of 11 | Exhibited at Level Up Showcase 2026

- Architected all core backend systems including level loading, state machines, custom player controllers, and a tree/node-based map with instantiated level objects
- Built seed-based randomization, progression tracking, a cinematic camera system with shake and pan effects, and a JSON-based leaderboard with a custom virtual keyboard for controller input
- Designed a modular tutorial system to accelerate iteration across the full development cycle
- Drove game design decisions across all aspects of the project, collaborating closely with the creative lead on scope, systems, and player experience
- Managed 4 programmers and collaborated with 6 artists to integrate assets and implement design changes throughout the project
- Managed scope throughout development by grounding the team vision in core essentials and expanding outward in a controlled, iterative manner
- Exhibited and demoed the game at Level Up Showcase, presenting to industry attendees and a panel of judges in a competitive showcase format

Lead Programmer and Designer | *Hardly Workin'* Sep 2024 – Apr 2025

Office simulation game | Unity, C# | Team project | Exhibited at Level Up Showcase 2025

- Developed in-world UI interactions, game and level state programming, and progress and performance tracking systems
- Implemented AI behaviours, mini-game integration, and full controller support
- Contributed significantly to game design decisions alongside programming responsibilities
- Exhibited and demoed the game at Level Up Showcase, presenting gameplay and design decisions to industry attendees and judges

Lead Programmer | *NovaShot* Jan 2024 – Apr 2024

Platformer | Unity, C#

- Developed core mechanics including a Black Hole Gun and dynamic level loading
- Designed and implemented all UI elements, and integrated sound effects and background music

INDUSTRY INVOLVEMENT

Game Developer and Exhibitor | *Level Up Showcase*

2025 – 2026

- Represented two student game projects, Cave Crashers and Hardly Workin', at Level Up, an annual Canadian competitive game industry showcase held in Toronto, ON
- Demoed both titles to industry professionals, studio representatives, and judges, fielding questions about design decisions, technical systems, and the development process

SKILLS

Languages: C#, Java, C++

Design: Game systems design, UI/UX, player experience, scope and feature planning

Engines and Tools: Unity3D (3+ years), Git, GitHub, Visual Studio Code, Helix

Game Systems: State machines, AI behaviour, controller input, JSON data persistence, procedural generation, level loading

Soft Skills: Technical leadership, cross-discipline collaboration, scope management, technical communication, public presentation

Productivity: Microsoft Office Suite, Google Workspace, Clockify